

EPC Tender Evaluation Report

Millbrook Solar & Storage – solar PV balance of plant

Liam McAllister · 04 September 2026 · MB-COM-RPT-0009

1. Recommendation

The evaluation panel recommends that **SunForge EPC Ltd** is appointed as preferred bidder for the solar PV balance-of-plant EPC contract at a lump-sum price of EUR 49.6 m, subject to planning consent, and that a limited notice to proceed for detailed design is considered after the planning decision in Q1 2027.

2. Tender process

The invitation to tender was issued on 22 May 2026 to five pre-qualified contractors. Three compliant bids were received by the deadline of 10 July 2026; two contractors declined to bid because of their workload in 2027/28. Two clarification rounds and bidder interviews on 4–5 August 2026 followed. The panel was Liam McAllister (chair), Sofie Lindqvist, Mei Tanaka, Laura Kessler (Procurement) and Lukas Meyer (Legal).

3. Scoring

Bidder	Price (EUR m)	Technical 40 %	Commercial 30 %	HSE 15 %	Programme 15 %	Weighted
SunForge EPC Ltd	49.6	84	81	88	80	83.10
Calder Solar Construction Ltd	51.2	79	74	82	77	77.65
Meridian Power Build GmbH	48.9	68	79	71	66	71.45

Scores out of 100; commercial score combines price, risk allocation and LDs

Meridian Power Build had the lowest price but excluded tracker foundations from the lump sum (provisional sum of EUR 1.8 m) and offered a 16-month programme against our 12-month target. Calder Solar's bid was technically strong but EUR 1.6 m more expensive than SunForge.

4. Key points of the SunForge offer

- Tracker: single-axis, 1P configuration, backtracking, ±55°; bifacial 580 Wp modules from two tier-1 suppliers
- Programme: 12 months from notice to proceed, mechanical completion in month 11
- Performance ratio guarantee 84.5 % in year 1; availability guarantee 99.0 % for 2 years
- Delay LDs 0.1 % of contract price per day, capped at 10 %
- Committed to the CTMP: haul road from B4127, no HGVs through Mill Lane village
- Local labour target 30 % of site hours within 30 km

5. Next steps

1. Preferred bidder letter issued 8 September 2026 (non-binding)

2. Contract negotiation in Q4 2026 – Q1 2027
3. Contract award after planning consent, target Q2 2027